

Victor Appleton

- *Kilmeny of the Orchard* by Lucy Maud Montgomery
- *What Will He Do With It: Book 10* by Edward Bulwer-Lytton
- *The Tragedy of the Korosko* by Arthur Conan Doyle
- *Dorothy Dainty's Gay Times* by Amy Brooks
- *Thistle and Rose: A Story for Girls* by Amy Walton
- *Ruth Fielding Homeward Bound: A Red Cross Worker's Ocean Perils* by Alice B. Emerson
- *Isla Heron* by Laura E. Richards
- *Frank Reade, Jr., Fighting the Terror of the Coast* by Anonymous

64k–128k

- *Lost in the Fog* by James De Mille
- *Dora Deane; Or, The East India Uncle* by Mary Jane Holmes
- *Going Some* by Rex Beach
- *A Pirate of Parts* by Richard Neville
- *The Backwoodsmen* by Charles G. D. Roberts
- *The Watchers: A Novel* by A. E. W. Mason
- *Discourses of Keidansky* by Bernard G. Richards
- *In Queer Street* by Fergus Hume
- *Dick Merriwell's Assurance; Or, In His Brother's Footsteps* by Burt L. Standish
- *The Earl's Promise, A Novel: Volume 2* by Mrs. J. H. Riddell

128k+

- *The Moon Pool* by Abraham Merritt
- *Under Two Flags* by Ouida
- *Born in Exile* by George Gissing
- *Esther Waters* by George Moore
- *Desert Conquest; or, Precious Waters* by A. M. Chisholm
- *The Dust Flower* by Basil King
- *Wager of Battle: A Tale of Saxon Slavery in Sherwood Forest* by Henry William Herbert
- *Betty Alden: The first-born daughter of the Pilgrims* by Jane G. Austin
- *Perch of the Devil* by Gertrude Atherton
- *The Brooklyn Murders* by G. D. H. Cole

B Example Prompts (T1)

What follows are three example prompts for the novel-level prediction of the 1898 novel "The Battle of the Strong: A Romance of Two Kingdoms"

by Gilbert Parker. Each prompt is run with a new user session.

Summary.

Source: "The Battle of the Strong: A Romance of Two Kingdoms" by Gilbert Parker.

Situation: You were given a narrative. You will now be given a task about the narrative. Complete the task. Keep your response brief and to the point.

Task: Summarize the narrative with one sentence per chapter. Describe what happens. Do not reference the narrative itself.

Limit your response to the narrative from chapter 1 up until, and including, chapter 12.

Storyworld description.

Source: "The Battle of the Strong: A Romance of Two Kingdoms" by Gilbert Parker.

Situation: You were given a narrative. You will now be given a task about the narrative. Complete the task. Keep your response brief and to the point.

Task: List each character in the narrative and their physical location in the story.

Here are a list of possible characters in the narrative: {characters}. The list might be blank.

If the character in the above list is present in the narrative, note their last location in the narrative. If a character is in the narrative but is not in the above list, still note their last location in the narrative. Be consistent with the name. Only list characters present in the narrative. Only list individuals. Do not list groups of characters.

Limit your response to the narrative from chapter 1 up until, and including, chapter 12.

JSON Schema follows.

Narrative time estimation.

Source: "The Battle of the Strong: A Romance of Two Kingdoms" by Gilbert Parker.

Situation: You were given a narrative. You will now be given a task about the narrative. Complete the task. Keep your response brief and to the point.

Task: Predict how much time in minutes, hours, or days elapsed in this narrative. Specify an exact number and unit. Only respond with a number and a unit, e.g. 30 minutes, 6 hours, or 1 day.

Limit your response to the narrative from chapter 1 up until, and including, chapter 12.

C Example GPT-4.1 responses.

Here we provide example summaries for *Christmas at Thompson Hall* by Anthony Trollope. These summaries were generated with GPT-4.1. We specifically provide the (concatenated) ground, and the summaries produced under treatments 2 (the whole unaltered novel), 3 (each chapter passed in as a separate user message), and 5 (chapters randomly shuffled) — with a full window of interest.

Ground. 1. During a harsh winter journey to attend a family Christmas gathering, an Englishwoman in a Paris hotel braves confusing corridors and an awkward encounter with staff to retrieve mustard as a remedy for her ailing husband's throat.

2. Mrs. Brown, after preparing a mustard plaster for her supposedly ill husband in a Paris hotel, accidentally applies it to the throat of a sleeping stranger in the wrong room, panics at her mistake, considers—but ultimately avoids—confessing to the night porter, and returns distraught and chilled to her own room.

3. Mrs. Brown, desperate to escape a French hotel after mistakenly putting a mustard plaster on a stranger instead of her ailing husband Mr. Brown, anxiously concocts excuses to persuade her reluctant husband to leave early while fearing discovery by the night porter and the injured stranger.

4. Mrs. Brown, after mistakenly entering a stranger's hotel room at night and inadvertently placing a mustard plaster on his throat instead of her husband's, faces public embarrassment and suspicion but ultimately explains the misunderstanding, allowing her and Mr. Brown to narrowly avoid

greater trouble and continue their journey, despite lingering awkwardness with the aggrieved stranger and staff.

5. A series of misunderstandings and mistaken identity occur when Mrs. Brown accidentally applies a mustard plaster to a stranger, Mr. Jones, at a hotel, leading to awkwardness and eventual reconciliation when it is revealed that Mr. Jones is engaged to Mrs. Brown's sister and all parties meet at Thompson Hall.

Treatment 2 (whole input). 1. During a bitterly cold Christmas journey to England, Mrs. Brown struggles with her husband's alleged illness and obtains mustard from their Paris hotel to treat his throat.

2. In the dark, Mrs. Brown mistakenly applies the mustard poultice to a stranger, Mr. Jones, instead of her husband, and flees in panic rather than wake or help him.

3. Distraught and desperate to leave the hotel to avoid a confrontation, Mrs. Brown invents excuses to hurry her husband's departure despite guilt and fear of discovery.

4. Mrs. Brown is confronted about the incident when the porter discovers her handkerchief in Mr. Jones's room, leading to an embarrassing explanation and apology to Mr. Jones, which allows them to continue their journey.

5. Upon arrival at Thompson Hall, Mrs. Brown and her husband awkwardly discover that the stranger from Paris, Mr. Jones, is her sister's fiancé, leading to the revelation of her mistake and eventual forgiveness during the family's Christmas celebration.

Treatment 3 (separate user messages). 1. Anxious to reach her family for Christmas despite her husband's complaints and illness, Mrs. Brown brings him to a cold Paris hotel, where he demands a mustard plaster for his throat.

2. In the middle of the night, Mrs. Brown becomes lost in the hotel while seeking mustard, then mistakenly applies the plaster to a stranger's throat instead of her husband's.

3. Discovering her error and unable to face the consequences, Mrs. Brown desperately tries to avoid detection and persuade her husband that they must leave quickly for England.

4. The Browns are confronted by hotel staff and the porter with evidence of the mishap, forcing Mrs. Brown to confess, after which her husband

explains the accident to the injured stranger, Mr. Jones, allowing them to depart.

5. Unexpectedly reunited at Thompson Hall, it is revealed that Mr. Jones is the fiancé of Mrs. Brown's sister, Jane, and after an awkward Christmas gathering, Mrs. Brown's mistake becomes a family anecdote, ultimately forgiven by all.

Treatment 5 (shuffled chapters). Certainly! Here is a one-sentence summary for each of chapters I to V:

Chapter I: On a cold Christmas in Paris, Mrs. Brown ventures through a labyrinthine hotel late at night to obtain mustard for her ailing husband's sore throat.

Chapter II: After a series of mishaps, Mrs. Brown mistakenly enters the wrong room and, believing the sleeping man is her husband, applies a mustard plaster to a stranger's throat.

Chapter III: Realizing her error and fearing exposure, Mrs. Brown slips away from the stranger, lies to her husband about her absence, and anxiously resolves they must escape early the next morning.

Chapter IV: As the Browns try to leave, Mrs. Brown is confronted by hotel staff who have evidence of her midnight blunder, leading to an awkward explanation and a necessary apology to the afflicted Mr. Jones before their delayed departure.

Chapter V: Traveling together by coincidence, the Browns and Mr. Jones arrive at Thompson Hall, where, amidst family gatherings and mounting suspicion, the truth of Mrs. Brown's comical mistake is ultimately revealed and reluctantly forgiven.

D Treatment Results

We provide all treated experiment results in [Figure 3](#).